Diocese of Pensacola-Tallahassee Document Retention Policy

1.0 Background

The Diocesan Financial Management (DFM) Guide to Best Practices was developed by the Committee on Budget and Finance (CBF) of the United States Conference of Catholic Bishops (USCCB), in conjunction with a sub-committee, the Accounting Practices Committee (APC), and it was initially approved by the full body of bishops at its November, 2002 General Meeting. The DFM was authorized for publication by Msgr. William P. Fay, General Secretary, USCCB.

The DFM is revised by the APC, revisions are reviewed and approved through the USCCB and the revised DFM is published on the USCCB website. The most recent update was drafted in *February, 2020*. Its contents are based upon generally accepted accounting principles in the United States at the time of its annual updates.

2.0 Overview

This Records Retention policy is recommended for all dioceses that are not subject to a litigation hold resulting from lawsuits, civil or criminal subpoenas, or canon law directives. Dioceses that are subject to litigation holds should comply with the requirements of the litigation holds.

3.0 Data Classification

3.1 Records retention policies should include paper records and electronic files, data, and e-mails. Such records should classified in one of the following categories:

- Administrative
- Personnel
- Financial
- Legal
- Property
- Cemetery
- Publications
- Sacramental

3.2 Digital documents, including but not limited to presentations, documents, worksheets, and databases, not be stored indefinitely. Understanding there are many reasons to keep these documents for a long period of time; future reference, re-use, etc., the I.T. Department will provide “long term storage” devices for end users upon request. These devices will be password protected and, when sensitive information may be stored on them, encryption will be required.

You will be able to move documents to departmental and personal folders on our server(s) and they are backed up nightly with a rolling two (2) week retention/recovery period.

If long term storage devices are used, they will be removed from the building or stored in the Pastoral Center Vault in the event of emergency.

Digital documents, including but not limited to presentations, documents, worksheets, and databases that pertain to legal or policy matters have specific Retention Periods that must be observed. These items may be copied to CD’s, DVD’s, or mobile storage devices then labeled and stored in a manner that will facilitate their removal in the event of an emergency. As feasible, hard copies of those documents should be made and stored appropriately.

4.0 Record Retention Periods

Within each group, records can be categorized into appropriate retention periods. Records older than the retention period should be destroyed. Those of permanent value should be stored appropriately. Some types of records should be stored for a very long time but may not need to be stored forever. For these records, consider a retention requirement category of “Destroy After 100 Years” or “Review After 100 Years.”

Confidential records should be made available only to diocesan/parish representatives with a legitimate right to know, unless their disclosure is compelled by some legal action.

Diocesan retention periods are in Appendix A of this policy.

Policy specifically regarding email retention is addressed in the *Diocese of Pensacola-Tallahassee Email Policy*, as published on the diocesan web site under Information Technology, IT Policies.

6.0 Definitions

Administration administration of the Records Management and Retention Program will be the responsibility of the Diocesan Archivist, with the Chancellor, who will publish the exact dates and confirm conformance to this policy by all departments. The Archivist will submit a written report of conformance to the Chancellor each year.

Certification of Disposal of Expired Records each year, every department head will submit to the Chancellor a letter testifying to the fact that all expired records pertaining to his/her department have been destroyed in accordance with the Records Retention Schedule.

Changes and Implementation changes to this policy or the Records Retention Schedule may be made only with the written approval of the Bishop. This policy will become effective upon approval of the Bishop with the first period for record disposal the month following promulgation.

Conservation no records shall be removed, destroyed, transferred, stored, transferred onto other media or otherwise disposed of except in compliance with diocesan policies.

Conversion to Electronic Medium paper records may be scanned or otherwise transferred to an electronic medium. When the conversion is complete the paper records will be destroyed in accordance with number 6 above.

Disposal of Expired Records annually, each department of the Diocese will dispose of records whose retention time has expired. Records may be shredded or, if electronic, deleted or destroyed by another approved method. No exceptions may be made, the retention times are absolute. Arrangements will be made for commercial shredding. A copy of the Certificate of Destruction will be executed and signed by the department head. One copy should be sent to Archives and the other retained by the department.

Off-Site Storage records that are generally inactive but must be retained permanently or for a set period of time will be stored off-site. Records will be prepared for storage annually. Boxes will be provided for the records. Each box will be identified with a label to be provided. A Certificate of Off-Site Storage must be completed in triplicate. One copy should be placed in the storage box. One copy sent to Archives and one copy retained by the department.

Ownership all records as defined above and created or preserved by a department, ministry or employee of the Diocese in the course of employment or in the transaction of diocesan business are solely the property of the diocese.

Records the word “records” used in this policy refers to all recorded information, documents, letters, maps, books, photographs, films, sound recordings, tapes (magnetic and otherwise), electronic data processing records, emails sent and received, recorded voicemails, electronic data banks and other documentary material created, received, maintained or preserved by any department or employee of the Diocese in the course of transaction of business or ministry or in pursuit of its legal obligations.

Retention periods retention periods in this policy are absolute, except when legally halted by official notice. They are not minimum guidelines. There are no exceptions.

Appendix A
Record Retention Schedule

The fact that a record is electronic, or email should not affect its retention. The schedule to be followed should be determined by the context of the record. For example, an email about finance matters would follow the schedule for financial records.					
Record Group	**Type of Record**	**Time**	**Medium**	**Retained**	**Disposal**
Administrative Records (ALL Departments)					
	Administrative Records (correspondence, memoranda, rules and regulations, etc.)				
	a. Records originating in the organization that document policy, procedure, rules or regulations	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	b. Records that document routine activities	2 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Abstracts, deeds (property)	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Annual reports to Pastoral Center (Status Animarum)	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Articles of Incorporation (of the church corporation, parish)	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Bequest and estate papers	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Bishop's Decrees	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Communications from the bishop regarding the parish	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Constitution and Bylaws (Diocesan Agencies)	Dissolution + 7 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Correspondence, legal	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Correspondence, official (*paper and email*) regarding diocesan directives and/or procedures	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Correspondence, routine	Biennial review	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Donor lists	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Finance Committee Minutes	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Insurance policies	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Inventories of property and equipment	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Leases	Expiration + 7 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Office files, general	Biennial review	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Diocesan Pastoral Council constitutions	Until superseded	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Diocesan Pastoral Council minutes	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Policy statements	Superseded + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Subject files (memos, rules, schedules, etc.)	Annual review	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Wills, testaments, codicils	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Archives					
	Parish History Files	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Deceased Clergy Files	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Photo Files (priests, parishes, institutions, general)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Clergy Card Files	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	

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Record Group	Type of Record	Time	Medium	Retained	Disposal
	Clergy Information Files	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Baptism Record Index Files	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Official Catholic Directories	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Former Bishops' Files	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Annuario Pontificio Directories	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Parish Boundaries, Decrees and Maps	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Historical Material (clippings, photos, booklets, etc. related to diocese and parishes)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Diocesan Directories (file copies)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Publications					
	Diocesan/Parish Histories	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Diocesan/Parish Anniversary Books	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Newsletters (diocesan, parish, affiliated organizations)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Parish Directories	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Parish Bulletins	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Bishop's Office					
	Bishop's Calendar	1 year	Paper	On-site/Off-site	Archives
	General Correspondence	Perm->file	Paper	On-site/Off-site	Archives
	Holy See/Nuncio Correspondence	Perm->file	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Official Diocesan Correspondence	Perm->file	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	USCCB Correspondence	Perm->file	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
Catholic Schools Office					
General	Standardized Test Results	10 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Curriculum Standards	Until superseded	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	School Calendar	Current year	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Crisis Management	1 year	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	DEET Financial Assistance Requests	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Enrollment Data	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Civil Rights/Title IX Reports	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	SEVIS/I-20 Foreign Student Program	3 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Diocesan School Board Minutes	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Diocesan School Board By-Laws	Until superseded	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Federal Program Requirements	5 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Articles of Incorporations/Trusts	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	NCEA Reports	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
AHERA	School Management Plans	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	

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Record Group	**Type of Record**	**Time**	**Medium**	**Retained**	**Disposal**
	Periodic Surveillance Reports	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	
	Abatement Documents & Manifests	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	
TCCED	School Annual Report for Continued Accreditation	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	
	School Self-Study Document	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	
	VT Consensus Report/Notification of Status	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	
	School Required Actions	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	
	Interim Reports	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	
	Guide to Quality and Effectiveness Manual	Until superseded + 5 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site/School	
	TCCED Health Manual	Until superseded	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site/School	
	Individual Deficiency Removal Plans/Verification	Termination + 5 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	
Education Personnel	Certificates and Licenses	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	
	Employee Service Record (including wage & salary)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site/School	
	Official Teacher Service Record	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site/School	
	Employment Applications (non-hires)	1 year from receipt	Paper/Elec	On-site	
	Official Transcripts	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	
	Employment Contracts	Last eff. date + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	
	Grievance Records (not EEOC)	2 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site/School	
	Training and Educational Attainment Records	Termination + 4 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site/School	
	CPE Course Rosters	Termination + 4 years	Paper/Elec	On-site	
Catechetical Services					
	Catechetical Student Database	Death of student	Electronic	On-site/Off-site	
	Contracts with Educational Institutions	Termination + 7 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Course Evaluation	3 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Diocesan Ministry Day Program Booklet	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Handbooks and Manuals	3 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Institutes (Christ the Servant and John Paul II)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Parish Catechetical Profile	5 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Renew/Why Catholic? Training Material	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	TCC-RE Annual Reports	Permanent	Electronic	On-site/Off-site	

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	TCC-RE Diocesan Reports	1 year	Electronic	On-site/Off-site	
	Religious Education Reports (for diocesan offices)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Chancellor					
	Claimant Files	Settlement + 10 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Ordination Records	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Settlement Files	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Clergy Assignment Letters (See Priest files)	Permanent -> Priests File	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
Communications					
	News Media Clippings	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Diocesan News Releases	5 years	Electronic	On-site/Off-site	
	Pastoral Center News	Permanent	Electronic	On-site/Off-site	
	Clergy Newsletter	Permanent	Electronic	On-site/Off-site	
Newspaper					
	Newspaper Back Issues	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Photos	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Subscription Database	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Website	Permanent	Electronic	On-site/Off-site	
	Freelancer Information	Permanent	Electronic	On-site/Off-site	
	Advertising Contracts	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Financial and Accounting					
Risk Management	Incident Reports (accidents/injury)	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Employee Medical Complaints	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Employee Medical Records	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Environmental Test Records/Reports	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Hazardous Exposure Records	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Toxic Substance Exposure Reports	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Workers Compensation Records	12 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Payroll	Permanent Earnings and Records	Termination + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Attendance Records	Termination + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Employee Contracts	Termination + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Employee Deduction Authorization	Termination + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Employee Salary Schedules	Termination + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	

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Record Group	**Type of Record**	**Time**	**Medium**	**Retained**	**Disposal**
	Labor Contracts	Termination + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	W-2 Years Forms	Filing + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	W-4 Years Forms	Filing + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Time Cards	Filing + 3 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Time Records	Filing + 3 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Banking	Bank Deposits	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Bank Statements	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Cancelled Checks	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Check Registers/Stubs	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
General	Audit Reports	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Balance Sheets, Annual	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Balance Sheets, Monthly/Quarterly	1 year	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Budgets, Approved, Revised	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Financial Reports, Annual	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Financial Reports, Monthly	1 year	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Financial Statements	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Investment/ Insurance	Certificates of Deposit, Cancelled	Redemption + 3 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Insurance Policies	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Mortgage Records	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Letters of Credit	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Securities Sales	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Stock Investment	Sale + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Accounting	Accounts Payable, Invoices	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Accounts Payable, Ledgers	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Accounts Receivable, Ledgers	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Credit Card Statements/Charge Slips	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Invoices and Paid Bills, Major Building Construction	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Invoices and Paid Bills, General Accounts	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Cash Books	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Cash Journals	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Cash Journal, Receipts on Offerings and Pledges	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Receipts	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Mortgage Payments	7 years	Pape/Elec	On-site/Off-site	

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Record Group	**Type of Record**	**Time**	**Medium**	**Retained**	**Disposal**
	Chart of Accounts	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Other Records	General Ledger, Annual	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Journals, General and Specific Funds	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Journal Entry Sheets	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Ledgers, Subsidiary	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Payroll Journals	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Payroll Registers (summary schedule of earnings, deductions & accrued leave)	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Pension Records	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Pledge Registers/Ledgers	3 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Permanently Restricted Gift Documents	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Temporarily Restricted Gift Documents	3 years after restrictions	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Tax Records	Employment Taxes (Contributions and payments including withholding & FICA)	File + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	W-2 Years Forms	File + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	W-4 Years Forms	File + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	IRS Exemption Determination Letters (other than OCD listed organizations)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Form 990	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	IRS Exemption Determination Letters (income, excise, property, sales, use, etc.)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Form 641	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Property Records	Architectural Records, Blueprints, Building Designs, Specifications	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Architectural Drawings	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Deeds Files	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Mortgage Documents	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Property Appraisals	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Real Estate Surveys/Plots, Plans	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Title Search Papers and Certificates	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Cemetery Records	Account Cards (record of lot ownership and payments)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Annual Report	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Bank Statements	7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Board Minutes	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Burial Cards (record of interred's name, date of burial, etc.)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Contracts Documenting Lot Ownership	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Correspondence	BANR	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	General Ledger	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	

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Record Group	**Type of Record**	**Time**	**Medium**	**Retained**	**Disposal**
	Lot Maps	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Human Resources					
Administrative Records	Employee Policy Manual	Superseded + 4 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Job Descriptions	Superseded + 4 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Organizational Chart	While Current	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	I-9 Years Audit	Permanent	Electronic	On-site/Off-site	
	Rejected Applications/Resumes	1 year after receipt	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Personnel Records	Employee Application	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Resume	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Employee Contracts/Offer Letters	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Salary Information	Termination + 4 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Attendance Records (jury, PTO, STD, LTD, FMLA, Bereavement)	Termination + 4 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Eligibility Verification Form I-9 Years	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Performance Reviews	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Write-Ups	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Promotions/Transfers	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
Benefit Records	Open Enrollment	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	New Hire	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Life Event	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Cont. of Benefits	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Term. Of Benefits	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Disability Records STD/LTD	Termination + 4 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	FMLA	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	403(b) Retirement Plan	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Life Insurance Policies	Termination + 4 years	Electronic	On-site/Off-site	
	Benefit Plan Description	Rollout + 4 years	Electronic	On-site/Off-site	
	Benefit Plan Annual Reports	6 years	Electronic	On-site/Off-site	
	Personnel File	Termination + 4 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	

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Pastoral Planning					
	Ad Limina Reports (Quinquennial Report)	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Annual Vatican Report	5 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Official Catholic Directory Report	5 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Official Catholic Directory Entity Financials	Current + 1 year	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	May and October Mass Counts	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Census Records (Parish)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Safe Environment					
	Application	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Screening Form	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Interviews	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	References	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Criminal Background Check	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Training Records	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Policy Acknowledgement	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Computer/Internal Policy	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	CPS Notifications	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Good Standing Records	Current + 1 year	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Non-Parish Organization Files	ACT + 3 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Parish/School Audits	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Tribunal					
	Prenuptial Files	6 years paper then electronic	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Nulity File Decision	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Nulity File Acta (other than decisions)	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Canonical Affairs Committee Records	5 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Vicar for Clergy					
	Priests' Personnel Files	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Deacons' Personnel Files	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Clergy Rescript Files	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
Youth Ministry					
	Waiver of Liability Forms	7 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Medical Release Forms	7 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Code of Conduct Forms	7 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Incident Report Forms	7 years after resolution	Paper	On-site/Off-site	

The fact that a record is electronic, or email should not affect its retention. The schedule to be followed should be determined by the context of the record. For example, an email about finance matters would follow the schedule for financial records.					
Record Group	**Type of Record**	**Time**	**Medium**	**Retained**	**Disposal**
Administrative Records (ALL Departments)					
	Administrative Records (correspondence, memoranda, rules and regulations, etc.)				
	a. Records originating in the organization that document policy, procedure, rules or regulations	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	b. Records that document routine activities	2 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Abstracts, deeds (property)	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Annual reports to Pastoral Center (Status Animarum)	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Articles of Incorporation (of the church corporation, parish)	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Bequest and estate papers	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Bishop's Decrees	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Communications from the bishop regarding the parish	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Constitution and Bylaws (Diocesan Agencies)	Dissolution + 7 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Correspondence, legal	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Correspondence, official (*paper and email*) regarding diocesan directives and/or procedures	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Correspondence, routine	Biennial review	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Donor lists	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Finance Committee Minutes	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Insurance policies	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Inventories of property and equipment	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Leases	Expiration + 7 years	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Office files, general	Biennial review	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Diocesan Pastoral Council constitutions	Until superseded	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Diocesan Pastoral Council minutes	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Policy statements	Superseded + 7 years	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Subject files (memos, rules, schedules, etc.)	Annual review	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Wills, testaments, codicils	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
Archives					
	Parish History Files	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Deceased Clergy Files	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	
	Photo Files (priests, parishes, institutions, general)	Permanent	Paper/Elec	On-site/Off-site	
	Clergy Card Files	Permanent	Paper	On-site/Off-site	